

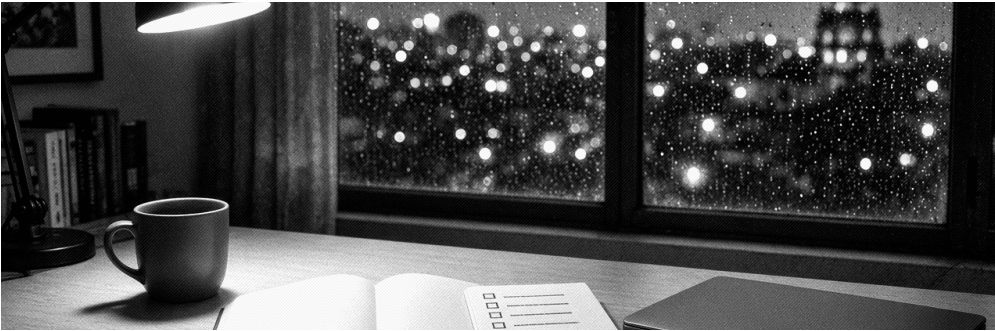
The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:50 A.M.

YOUR DAY

Checkpoint shares 10 p.m. with Journaling; GDG reminder overnight; audiogram still red

Tonight's Checkpoint block starts at the same time as Journaling. GDG CDMX refreshed the Friday Maps + AI session overnight. Audiogram-inbox verify failures continued into early Wednesday. Hetzner's final warning still has no payment-received follow-up. La Casa de Satoshi and the Buildathon remain approved in mail and still missing from the calendar.



Ferdinand, Checkpoint day is on the calendar tonight from 10:00 p.m. to midnight, and Journaling is booked for the first hour of that same window. Coffee & AI Social was yesterday at Café Comunidad—Luma traffic from the meetup is still in the inbox—so today is back to the weekday skeleton until those evening blocks.

Overnight mail is mostly follow-through. GDG CDMX sent another note for Friday's Maps Platform + AI codelab at 7:00 p.m. CST (AI Studio, Maps, Gemini, deploy to Cloud Run). Audiogram-inbox kept landing GitHub noise: Codex reviews on newer PRs and another failed pull-request checks run on the Jev→YouTube clip work. Hetzner's Final Payment Warning from Friday is still open after the weekend login verification; nothing newer says the block cleared. Looking ahead, La Casa de Satoshi on October 6 and the Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon on October 9 are still approved in Luma and still not on Google Calendar.

TODAY

6:00–6:30	News / catchup	RECURRING
6:30–8:30	Swim	RECURRING
10:15 / 3:00	Food	RECURRING
4:00–6:30	Miami	RECURRING
6:30–10:00	Discovery	RECURRING
10:00–12:00	Checkpoint day Personal checklist only; overlaps Journaling	RECURRING
10:00–11:00	Journaling Same start as Checkpoint	RECURRING

THIS WEEK

WED SEP 30 — Checkpoint day 10:00 p.m.–midnight; overlaps Journaling.
THU OCT 1 — Weekday skeleton (News / Swim / Miami / Discovery).
FRI OCT 2 — GDG CDMX: Maps Platform + AI, 7:00 p.m. CST; AI Studio + Maps + Gemini + Cloud Run.
TUE OCT 6 — ¿La IA nos matará a todos? 6–9 p.m.; La Casa de Satoshi; approved (not on calendar).
WED OCT 7 — Next weekly Checkpoint day.
FRI OCT 9 — Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon, 5–9 p.m.; Sandbox Hub CDMX; approved.

WEATHER

~25° / ~14° HIGH / LOW

Cool and overcast at compile (~15°C). The afternoon warms into the mid-20s with light rain showers, and the chance of rain climbs hard toward early evening. Pack a light layer if you are out between Miami and Discovery.

THU	Partly cloudy a.m.; showers / evening rain risk	~24 / ~14
FRI	Cloudy with showers; stronger evening rain	~23 / ~14
SAT	Continued shower pattern	~22 / ~14
SUN	Heavy shower risk lingering	~20 / ~14

NEEDS A LOOK

CALENDAR	ACTION
Checkpoint overlaps Journaling at 10:00 p.m. Same start; personal checklist only.	
GDG CDMX	FYI
Maps Platform + AI — Friday 7:00 p.m. Overnight reminder; AI Studio + Maps + Gemini + Cloud Run.	
GITHUB ACTIONS	FYI
Audiogram-inbox verify / PR checks still failing. Overnight activity on newer PRs including Jev→clips.	
HETZNER BILLING	ACTION
Final warning; services still marked blocked. Fri PDF still open; no payment-received mail.	
LUMA / LA CASA DE SATOSHI	ACTION
AI-risk talk — still approved, still off calendar. Tue Oct 6, 6–9 p.m.; ticket in mail.	
REAP LATAM / LUMA	FYI
Agentic Buildathon spot approved. Fri Oct 9, 5–9 p.m., Sandbox Hub CDMX.	

TONIGHT

Discovery into Checkpoint + Journaling at 10:00 p.m.; showers likelier by evening — see On the Town for Thu/Sat outs.

DUE

Hetzner final warning / services blocked (still open).

INBOX

TLDR

OpenAI DevDay, Apple's reorg, data is the app

FROM TLDR

OpenAI stacked more than 20 DevDay launches; Apple's new CEO wants faster, leaner product cycles; a short essay argues agents can rewrite code but not replace the data.

DEVDAY 2026 RECAP

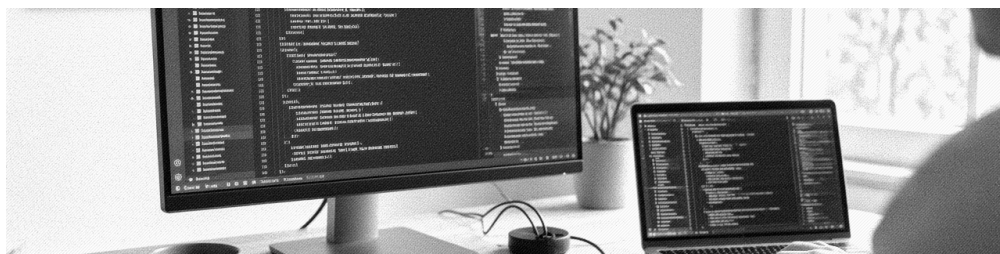
OpenAI made more than 20 major announcements across ChatGPT, Codex, its models, and more at DevDay 2026. It introduced agents that can take on ongoing responsibilities and new ways for people and AI to work together. The company also expanded its commitment to an open ecosystem by opening up ChatGPT as a shared surface where humans and agents can collaborate and where developers can directly launch new native experiences. There is now a new Pro 500 plan that offers 25 times the ChatGPT Plus allowance and includes access to Ultrafast.

APPLE'S NEW CEO SEEKS TO MAKE COMPANY RUN FASTER AND LEANER

Apple CEO John Ternus is moving to overhaul the company to accelerate product development, broaden its range of devices, and create a leaner organization with a greater focus on engineering. Early ideas under consideration include relying less on traditional spring and fall product release schedules and eliminating some middle-management positions. Ternus has indicated that the company should introduce products more quickly and become more experimental to remain competitive in the AI era.

DATA IS THE APPLICATION

AI makes it possible to build faster than ever. However, none of that speed applies to the data. Lose the data that users give you, and you have to start all over again. Let agents iterate over the code, but leave the data to humans.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: TLDR also flags NASA's Crew Dragon problem after SpaceX said it does not want those LEO flights after supporting the station through 2030, plus a Joby pilotless Caravan demo over Wichita. Quick links include Google testing payments to sites used in AI results, a Firefox redesign interview, and Terry Tao on how AI does and does not change math research.

BYTEBYTEGO

Why Do LLMs Lie?

FROM BYTEBYTEGO

A support-bot invents a 30-day refund for a 14-day policy—then a tour of hallucinations, RAG, tools, and checks before the customer sees the answer.

A customer asks a company's new AI-based support assistant whether a subscription purchased 15 days ago qualifies for a refund. Let's assume that the assistant responds immediately by explaining that the company offers a 30-day refund window, describes the cancellation process, and promises that the money will arrive within five working days. All of it sounds quite helpful, confident, and complete.

But there is just one problem.

In reality, the company only allows refunds within 14 days. Also, there is no promise about the 5-day processing time. The assistant has actually taken bits of a plausible policy and invented a fake commitment out of thin air. In other words, it has lied. The customer now expects something that the company never offered.

Though this example might sound fictitious, it shows one of the most important problems in applications built with LLMs. While LLMs can produce excellent language, they can get the underlying information totally wrong.

In this article, we will look at why this problem of hallucinations happens with LLMs and the techniques that can help make LLMs more dependable for answering.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: ByteByteGo separates factual errors, faithfulness failures against supplied evidence, and outright fabrication, then shows how next-token prediction produces fluent guesses rather than verified claims. The rest walks through RAG, account-lookup tools, answering "needs review" when evidence is incomplete, and checking claims and citations before a reply ships. The close is a workflow: retrieve the policy, fetch the account facts, check conditions, verify the explanation, and route judgment calls for review.

INBOX

EVERY

Vibe Check: OpenAI DevDay 2026

BY DAN SHIPPER

With 20-plus launches, Shipper names the five that mattered after a few days of hands-on testing—and which still feel rough.

OpenAI announced more than 20 products and features at DevDay today. By my count, no Dev-Day since the first one in 2023 has come close. Together, they make OpenAI's plan plain: ChatGPT as the operating system for your work, with agents, documents, and other companies' apps all running inside it.

I've tested the biggest launches for the past few days. Some of them have already changed how I work. A lot of it doesn't work reliably yet. Dots, OpenAI's always-on agents, became my main way to use ChatGPT. Mine caught that a flight change would clash with a meeting request in a Slack thread I hadn't read. It also dropped messages, tripped over permissions, and often couldn't reach its browser.

I wrote the review in Space, OpenAI's new home for docs, slides, and spreadsheets. Edits show up faster than when an agent works in Google Docs, and you can tag your dot in a comment. Getting a team off Google or Notion will be harder.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Shipper also tried the Decisions API against Jev on two internal tests (mixed speed/accuracy), notes Plus/Pro usage now carrying into about 15 partner apps including Devin, and suggests waiting a week if you dislike rough edges—or staying put if you already like other bot stacks. The email is a free preview; later sections on plugin extensions, the Pro 500 plan, and Sol 6.1 sit behind the wall.

THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

Why has Shopify dropped React Native?

FROM THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

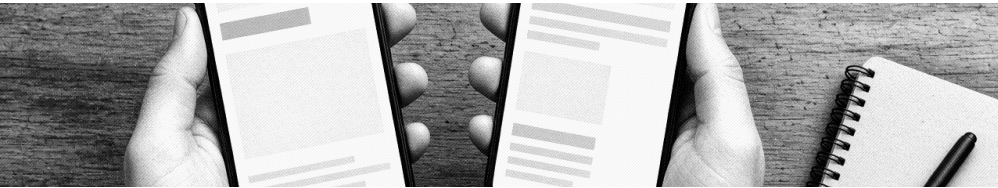
After five happy years on React Native, Shopify is moving mobile back to Swift and Kotlin—because coding agents changed the cost of shipping native twice.

Recently, Shopify dropped the bombshell announcement that Native is now the future of mobile development at the e-commerce platform. This triggered a lot of reaction in the mobile development community, on the scale of the stir Shopify generated when it originally moved over to React Native six years ago.

But times have changed, and we all know the agent of change this time: AI agents! This latest generation of models has improved in coding capability to the extent that Shopify no longer is satisfied with React Native (RN), as it was only last year.

This article looks into what led here, why Shopify made the change, and also the broader mobile ecosystem—including why Shopify chose React Native in 2020, stayed happy five years, and rewrote the Shop app to native in just 12 weeks.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: The piece recounts Clubhouse's slow Android launch as the kind of delay RN once solved, then quotes Shopify's 2025 "five years of React Native" victory lap before Mustafa Ali's reversal: agents now cover enough implementation and porting that shared RN code matters less than staying close to platform tooling. It compares Airbnb's earlier RN retreat, notes Notion's long native migration, and flags Kotlin Multiplatform as another path. Shop already shipped native in 12 weeks; the other apps are next under the same quality bar.



THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

Queen Budapest – in cinemas from Oct 7

The 1986 Budapest stadium show—the last Queen concert filmed with Freddie Mercury—is getting a 4K restoration for theaters and IMAX. Peter Jackson's Park Road Post cleaned the original 35 mm; the band's team remixed the multitracks. If you want the Magic Tour in a dark room rather than a phone tab, the theatrical window starts October 7.

Sanxingdui: Future Past – AI feature aims for Oct 23

Bona Film Group says this 100-minute sci-fi is China's first theatrical film that used AI across production and still earned a screening license. Characters are original digital creations, not scans of living actors, and a large human team kept story and final calls. The production spent two years and more than a million source images chasing shot-to-shot consistency.

ON THE TOWN



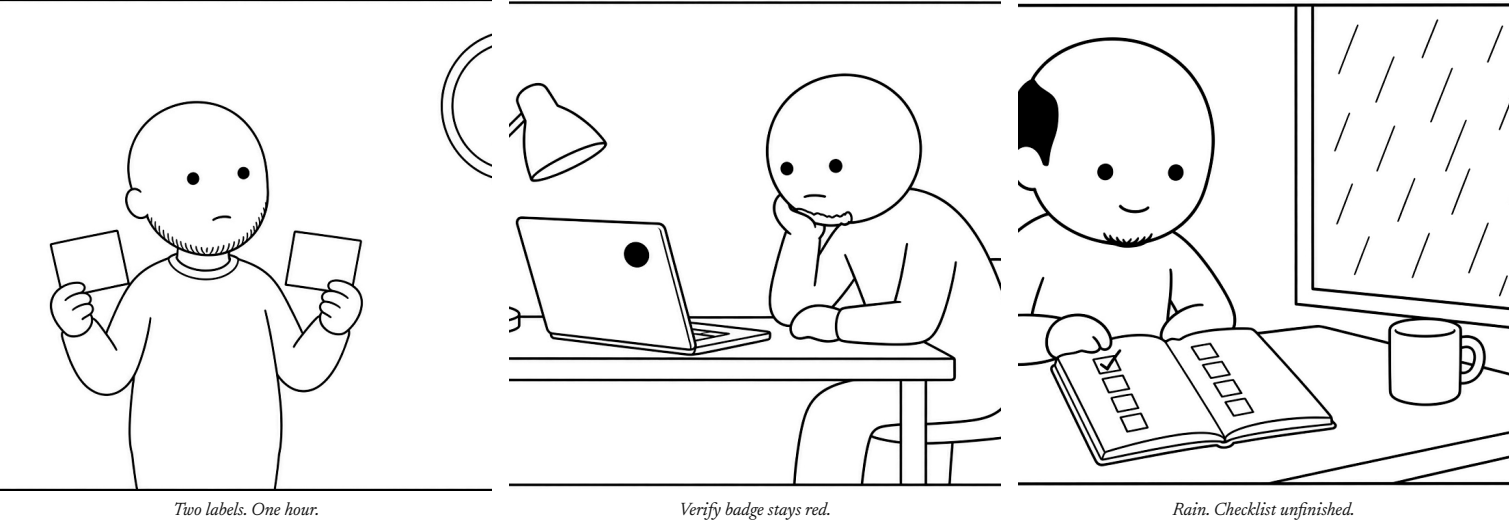
Mondo Cane con Mike Patton – Thu Oct 1, 8:00 p.m., Palacio de Bellas Artes

Patton sings mid-century Italian pop with orchestral arrangements—think Morricone's "Deep Down" and Gino Paoli's "Senza Fine" rather than Faith No More volume. About 90 minutes in the Bellas Artes main hall as part of the Circuito Cervantino. Listings say the Mexico City date is sold out; useful mainly if hunting returns or already holding a ticket.

Amadeus Live – Sat Oct 3, 7:30 p.m., Auditorio Nacional

The Oscar-winning Amadeus plays on a large screen while orchestra and choir perform the Mozart cues in sync. Minería's pops series is presenting it; about two hours of film-plus-live-score. Indoor Saturday plan if Discovery can flex.

PUZZLES



MINI CROSSWORD

1	2	3	4	5
6				
7				
8				
9				

ACROSS

1 What evening showers do around Miami / Discovery time

6 How ByteByteGo’s support customer sounds trusting a invented refund

7 What Google’s AI-results pilot may start paying (web —)

8 Friday’s GDG Maps + AI session, or tonight’s Checkpoint block

9 What audiogram-inbox verify jobs keep failing overnight

DOWN

1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)

2 Same as 6-Across

3 Same as 7-Across

4 Same as 8-Across

5 Same as 9-Across

ONSET · NAIVE · SITES · EVENT · TESTS

DEAR TIMES

Checkpoint and Journaling both start at 10—do I merge them?

Dear Times, Checkpoint day is on the calendar from 10:00 p.m. to midnight, and Journaling is set for 10:00–11:00 p.m. Audiogram-inbox is still failing verify. Do I combine the checklist into the journaling hour, or keep them separate and cut Discovery short?

– Overlapped in Mexico City

Dear Overlapped, Use the shared 10:00 p.m. hour as one sitting: run the Checkpoint checklist first, then write the journaling prompts in whatever time remains before midnight. Discovery can end at 10 without a second evening block. Leave the red verify jobs for a morning gap—they do not need the same hour as the checklist.

– The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus. What keeps filling when audiogram-inbox verify jobs fail overnight (4 letters).

KCEHC

□□□□○

IWMS

○□□□

ANIR

□□○□

OECD

□□○□

CHECK SWIM RAIN CODE · DISK

WANTED

One 10:00 p.m. slot that can hold Checkpoint and Journaling without asking which label wins. Applicants must arrive already holding a short checklist and a blank page.

Calendar entries for two already-approved October events.

La Casa de Satoshi (Oct 6) and the Agentic Buildathon (Oct 9) have tickets in mail. Citizens who cleared Luma are advised to drag both onto the calendar before Friday’s GDG note is the only future item in view.

FOR SALE

Slightly used “I’ll fix verify tomorrow” stack. Includes unread GitHub threads from audiogram-inbox and a badge that stays red overnight. Buyer accepts that Codex review comments are not a green check.

Spare “always-on agent” envy (conceptual). Inspired by Every’s DevDay dots catching Slack conflicts. Does not clear a Hetzner warning. Transfers as FYI only.

NOTICES

Department of Evening Rain

High near 25°C, shower odds rising toward early evening. Umbrellas useful between Miami and Discovery. This is weather, not an RSVP.

Municipal GDG reminder

Maps Platform + AI, Friday 7:00 p.m. CST. Not present on Google Calendar. Please do not confuse with Checkpoint tonight or Amadeus Live on Saturday.